

ApproxDPPoint::beta

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This proof resides in “contrib” because it has not completed the vetting process.

1 Hoare Triple

Precondition

Compiler-verified

- Receiver `self` of type `ApproxDPPoint`
- Argument `alpha` of type `RBig`

Caller-verified

`alpha` is in $[0, 1]$, and `self` was constructed by `ApproxDPPoint::build` from finite nonnegative ϵ and $\delta \in [0, 1]$.

Pseudocode

```
1 def beta(  
2     self: ApproxDPPoint,  
3     alpha: RBig,  
4 ) -> RBig:  
5     t1 = self.one_minus_delta - self.exp_eps_up * alpha  
6     base = max(self.one_minus_delta - alpha, RBig(0))  
7     t2 = self.exp_neg_eps_down * base  
8     return max(max(t1, t2), RBig(0))
```

Postcondition

Theorem 1.1. For all $\alpha \in [0, 1]$, `ApproxDPPoint::beta` returns a value no greater than the exact approximate-DP tradeoff curve $f_{\epsilon, \delta}(\alpha)$.

Definition 1.2. For an `ApproxDPPoint` with parameters ϵ and δ , define

$$f_{\epsilon, \delta}(\alpha) = \max(0, 1 - \delta - \exp(\epsilon)\alpha, \exp(-\epsilon) \max(1 - \delta - \alpha, 0)). \quad (1)$$

Proof. The receiver was constructed by `ApproxDPPoint::build`, which stores exact rational conversions of directed interval endpoints satisfying

$$\text{self.exp_eps_up} \geq \exp(\epsilon), \quad \text{self.exp_neg_eps_down} \leq \exp(-\epsilon).$$

The pseudocode uses these cached constants with exact rational arithmetic.

For $\alpha \in [0, 1]$, the first affine branch is no greater than

$$1 - \delta - \exp(\epsilon)\alpha,$$

because `self.exp_eps_up` is an upper bound and α is nonnegative. If $1 - \delta - \alpha \geq 0$, the second branch satisfies

$$\text{self.exp_neg_eps_down}(1 - \delta - \alpha) \leq \exp(-\epsilon)(1 - \delta - \alpha).$$

If the base is negative, the pseudocode replaces it with zero, which is no greater than the exact branch and is consistent with the outer maximum. Taking the maximum with zero therefore preserves the pointwise lower bound.

Thus `ApproxDPPoint::beta` returns a value no greater than $f_{\epsilon, \delta}(\alpha)$. This is the required reporting behavior because a smaller β is a weaker tradeoff guarantee. $\square$